LakeLife

AUDIENCE & MARKET STUDY

Know the owner. Understand the household.

A local desk study and a practical plan to validate demand.



INTERNAL / RESEARCH

Audited 17 October 2026

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01 / THE LOCAL STARTING POINT

Three lakes. Two county contexts.

Begin with Big Long, Pretty and Big Turkey Lakes in Indiana. Big Long and Pretty are in LaGrange County; Big Turkey crosses LaGrange and Steuben Counties. Build the actual prospect map around crew travel and property fit.

2020-2024 CENSUS ESTIMATES	LAGRANGE COUNTY	STEUBEN COUNTY
Households	12,897	14,058
Owner-occupied housing rate	83.0%	79.5%
Median household income[1]	$84,487	$74,911
Households with broadband subscription	66.9%	87.3%

[1] Income is stated in 2024 dollars. These are county-wide estimates; they do not describe lakefront households, seasonal owners or park renters specifically.

What this tells us

There is a broader regional household base, but the 26,955 combined households are not LakeLife's addressable market. Lakefront counts, eligible park lots, willingness to pay and serviceable crew capacity still need to be measured.

> **Practical inference:** offer both self-service and office-assisted onboarding. County broadband differences justify testing access options; they do not establish any individual resident's ability or preference.

Geography: Indiana DNR lake levels and Indiana DNR lake listing. Population context: Census QuickFacts: LaGrange; Census QuickFacts: Steuben. Same ACS 2020-2024 period used throughout; reviewed 17 October 2026.

02 / PRIORITY AUDIENCES

Choose by need, not by stereotype.

PRIORITY / ROLE	JOB THEY NEED DONE	TRIGGER / FIRST PROOF
1 / Independent park owner	Know what is owed and what work remains, with a record the office can explain.	A disputed balance, a shared expense, seasonal turnover or scattered work notes. Show one lot and one completed task.
2 / Park manager or office lead	Keep day-to-day records accurate without increasing repetitive questions.	A billing run, payment reconciliation or repeated maintenance follow-up. Let them run the workflow themselves.
3 / Renter in a participating park	Understand their own bill and know what happened to a reported issue.	A new bill, a receipt question or a maintenance concern. Show their own account and the office contact route.
4 / Lake homeowner	Arrange a specific service and see the price and completion proof.	Seasonal closing/opening, a missed service or a trip arriving soon. Start with one available job.
Enabler / Local crew	Receive clear job details and complete work with a reliable record.	Open route capacity and suitable work. Confirm scope, access, photos and actual payment terms.

These profiles are hypotheses based on the product's workflows, not findings from interviews. Validate the need, decision process and language with real people before narrowing the message further.

> **Buyer and user differ:** the owner approves the park agreement; the office runs much of the process; renters experience the result. A strong owner sale includes a resident-friendly launch plan.

03 / THE DECISION JOURNEY

Remove one uncertainty at a time.

“What is it?”	Use a single sentence: “LakeLife brings park rent records, shared costs and property work into one place.” Avoid listing the whole platform before establishing the need.
“Does it fit us?”	Ask how they handle a recent bill or task. Use their workflow in the walkthrough, including cash/check records and the office’s existing practices.
“Will setup be hard?”	Show the data checklist, who reviews it and what happens before residents are invited. Agree on a scope; do not promise a fixed migration time.
“What will it cost?”	Explain the final park fee and any separate processing or service charges in the written proposal. Keep household services separate from rent.
“Will residents use it?”	Demonstrate one account from a resident’s view. Include printed instructions and office assistance. Track actual access, not just invitations sent.
“Can I trust it?”	Show the opening-balance review, payment status language, completed-work evidence and the person who handles questions.

The closing question

“If this handled the billing and work record we just reviewed, what would you need to see before starting with your park?”

Test these objections in discovery. Do not present them as quotes from customers or claim the walkthrough has already resolved them.

04 / ALTERNATIVES IN THE SALE

Respect the existing choice.

ALTERNATIVE	OFFICIALLY DESCRIBED STRENGTHS	LAKELIFE SALES IMPLICATION
Rent Manager	Manufactured-housing tools include accounting, metered utilities, assets and resident functions. Pricing is quote-based.	Ask whether the owner already relies on these broader functions. Demonstrate a local workflow; avoid an unsupported replacement claim.
Buildium	Property accounting, resident portal, maintenance and online-payment features. Essential is advertised from $62/month; terms and added fees matter.	A mature property-management alternative. Compare the actual required package, setup and support, not a headline price alone.
Campspot	Campground reservation software with recurring guest billing, point of sale and other operating tools. Contact for applicable pricing.	Especially relevant if the real need is nightly reservations or campground distribution. Qualify that need before pitching LakeLife.
Spreadsheet + bank + phone	Familiar tools with little perceived switching effort. Fragmented records are a hypothesis to test, not a universal fact.	Ask for a recent example of duplicated work. Show the smallest workflow that improves it.

> **Defensible differentiation to test:** local service coordination and work evidence alongside the park's record. Do not claim unique features, quantified savings or that competitors lack capabilities without testing them.

Primary sources, reviewed 17 October 2026: Rent Manager manufactured housing / pricing; Buildium pricing; Campspot pricing. Descriptions summarize vendor pages, not independent tests. Prices can change; obtain current quotes before a formal comparison.

05 / LOCAL RESEARCH ROUTES

Start with real places. Verify the fit.

PUBLIC ORGANIZATION / BUSINESS	EVIDENCE SIGNAL	USEFUL NEXT CONVERSATION
Big Long Lake Association	Public membership page describes newsletters, community activity and business-supported directory efforts.	Ask about permitted introductions or advertising. Never assume access to a member list.
Big Turkey Lake Improvement Association	A local lake association with a public site.	Ask which seasonal-care or property-coordination questions members raise.
Indian Lakes Campground	Public seasonal offering includes adjacent needs such as slips, storage and mowing inquiries.	How are seasonal guest records and optional services coordinated today?
Manapogo RV Campground	Public rules describe seasonal guests and existing payment options, including ACH.	What remains difficult even with an established payment process?
Atwood Lake Campground	Public seasonal-camping offering near the wider local market.	Which workflows are recurring, and which are reservation-specific?

These are desk-research examples, not customers, partners, endorsements or verified sales leads. The campgrounds may fall outside the founding-lake route. Confirm location, decision-maker, operational fit and coverage before treating any as a prospect.

Primary pages: Big Long membership; Big Turkey association; Indian Lakes seasonal; Manapogo rules and FAQ; Atwood seasonal camping. Reviewed 17 October 2026. No contact was made.

06 / SIZE FROM THE GROUND UP

Count what can be served.

A useful launch market is a verified list of properties and people with a recurring need. It is not a percentage of county population.

INVENTORY TO BUILD	FIELDS TO VERIFY	WHY IT MATTERS
Parks	Location, decision-maker, recurring lots, eligible software lots, existing tools, next billing cycle.	Creates a park-fee opportunity range and a realistic discovery list.
Households	Property location, service need, season, current provider, permission to follow up.	Connects demand to a specific service rather than a generic audience.
Crews	Coverage, available days, services, insurance, unit costs and job limits.	Sets the serviceable market and route capacity.
Adoption evidence	Qualified conversation, walkthrough, agreement, activated account and completed service.	Distinguishes interest from actual use.

Bottom-up model

Annual park fee opportunity = verified eligible lots × agreed monthly rate × paid months.

Annual household service spend = verified reachable households × likely booked jobs per year × average job total. Apply conversion and capacity limits before forecasting.

Illustration only: 100 eligible lots at $8 for 12 months = $9,600 in park fees. Separately, 40 households × 3 jobs × $300 = $36,000 in service spend; at illustrative 12% customer and crew fees, a 21.43% gross platform share is approximately $7,714.29 before processing, rework and overhead. These inputs are not observed local counts.

> Avoid adding all county households, seasonal sites and park households together: they may overlap. Maintain separate unique records, and deduplicate before estimating demand.

07 / VALIDATE BEFORE SCALING

Twelve conversations can change this plan.

PROPOSED INTERVIEW SAMPLE	QUESTIONS TO ASK	EVIDENCE TO CAPTURE
5 park owners / office leads	Walk me through the last billing issue or unfinished task. What do you use now? What would make switching worthwhile?	A specific recent example; current tools; decision-maker; setup concerns; willingness to review a scoped offer.
4 residents, with park permission	How do you check a bill or ask about a repair? What would make access easier?	Actual steps, confusing wording and preferred assistance; no unnecessary financial details.
3 lake homeowners	What was the last service you arranged? How did you select a provider and know it was finished?	Service frequency, timing, proof expectations and reaction to a real scoped quote.

Two simple tests

Owner message Test “Your park, in one place” against “A clearer record of what is owed and what needs doing.” Use similar outreach groups; compare qualified walkthroughs, not likes.

Resident onboarding Observe someone using the printed guide and someone receiving office help. Record completion, questions and incorrect account links; stop and correct access errors.

> **Decision rule, proposed:** continue the pilot when owners identify a repeated problem, can complete the chosen workflow and agree to a specific next step at disclosed terms. Revise the offer if interest does not survive the walkthrough.

Study method: desk research from official pages plus current project review, completed 17 October 2026. No interviews or surveys have yet been conducted. Sample sizes above are a proposed qualitative learning plan; they will not produce statistically representative market estimates.